

Clause 10: Improvement

10.1. General

The organization is required to determine and select opportunities for improvement and implement any necessary actions to meet customer requirements and enhance customer satisfaction



Results of analysis and evaluation of environmental, quality and health & safety performance, compliance, internal audits and management reviews.

- ✓ Meet customer requirements and enhance customer satisfaction
 - ✓ Improve products and services to meet requirements as well as to address future needs and expectations. Focus on improving products and services (future needs and expectations, investment in latest technology and innovation, improving reliability, reducing cost, and improving on-time delivery)
 - ✓ Correcting, preventing or reducing undesired effects by investigating root cause, preventing escapes to the customer, acting on customer feedback and/or in service reports
 - ✓ Improving the performance and effectiveness of the QMS by acting on process performance results, understanding audit findings, reducing waste, process re-engineering, structural re-organization, and promoting breakthrough projects.
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Auditing

- ✓ Ensure the organization has identified opportunities for improvement
- ✓ Evaluate actions that have been taken on those opportunities
- ✓ Look for evidence that the organization is analyzing data from process monitoring (internal communication, follow-up activities, documented procedures, the effectiveness of management review meetings, customer feedback systems, and training programs)
- ✓ Verify how the organization has determined a “proposed rate of improvement”

An auditor should remember that it would be unrealistic to expect an organization to make progress on all potential improvements simultaneously.